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EXPERIMENT-06: Extracting Browser Artifacts

AIM:

To extract and examine browser artifacts, including browsing history, cached files, visited URLs, and associated timestamps using forensic utilities.

TOOLS REQUIRED:

1. ChromeHistoryView
2. ChromeCacheView
3. IEHistoryView
4. IECacheView
5. Windows computer with browser data available

PROCEDURE:

Step 1: Download the Tools

- Download the utilities from the official NirSoft website and extract the downloaded ZIP files.
- ChromeHistoryView: https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/chrome_history_view.html
- ChromeCacheView: https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/chrome_cache_view.html
- IEHistoryView: https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/ie_history_view.html
- IECacheView: https://www.nirsoft.net/utils/ie_cache_view.html

Step 2: Examine Browser History

- Launch ChromeHistoryView.
- Select the available Chrome history database or user profile.
- Examine visited URLs, page titles, visit counts, and timestamps.
- Export relevant records if required.

Step 3: Examine Browser Cache

- Open ChromeCacheView.
- Load or locate the supported Chrome cache directory.

- Examine cached URLs, content types, file sizes, and access information.
- Record relevant findings.

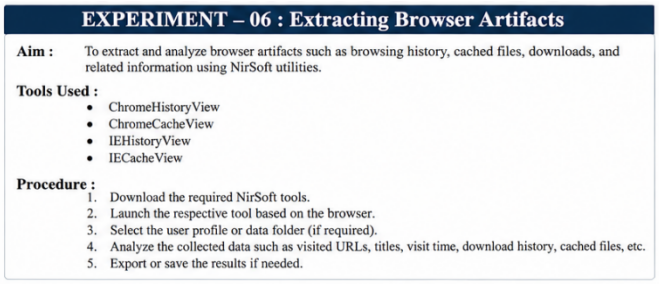
Step 4: Examine Internet Explorer Artifacts

- Launch IEHistoryView to inspect available Internet Explorer history records.
- Open IECacheView to examine supported Internet Explorer cache data.
- Record the available URLs, timestamps, and cache metadata.

Note: Internet Explorer is retired. These tools may be useful for legacy artifacts, but compatibility depends on the Windows version and available data.

Step 5: Document Findings

Record relevant browser artifacts and timestamps in an observation table. Export results where supported and capture screenshots of the actual application output.



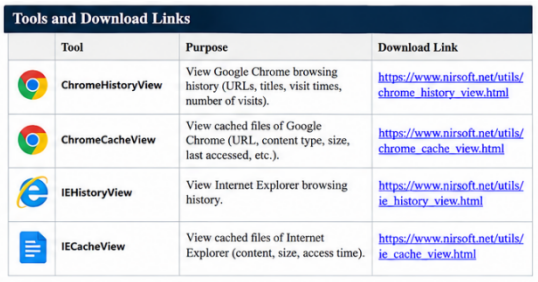




Figure 1: Downloading ChromeHistoryView from NirSoft Website

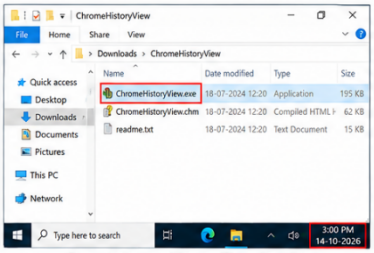


Figure 2: Extracted ChromeHistoryView Files

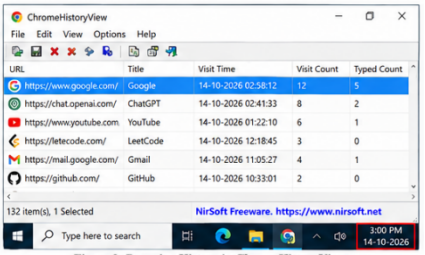


Figure 3: Browsing History in ChromeHistoryView

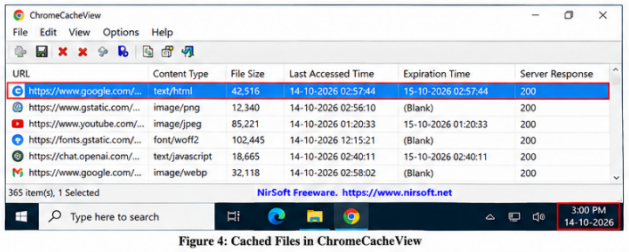


Figure 4: Cached Files in ChromeCacheView

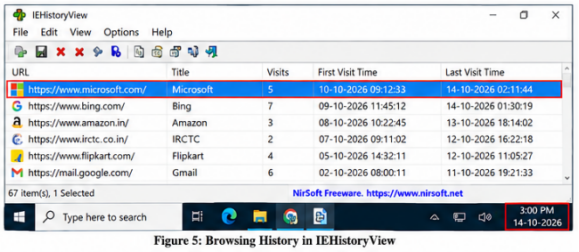


Figure 5: Browsing History in IEHistoryView

RESULT:

1. The tools successfully extracted detailed browsing history and cache information.
2. Investigators obtained a timeline and context of user internet activities.
3. The extracted artifacts aided in constructing web usage profiles, valuable for forensic and investigative purposes.